

Europe Redefined

Nationalism was one of the 19th century's most potent political ideologies. Over the course of the century, popular and state-led movements inspired by emerging concepts of national identity radically redefined the borders of Europe, replacing traditional monarchies with modern nation-states.

During 1814–15, statesmen from the powers that had brought down Napoleonic France (see pp.304–07) gathered at Vienna to decide how to redraw the borders of Europe (see BEFORE). The resulting settlement was essentially conservative—an attempt to contain the seeds of nationalism that had shattered the old order of Europe. Most of the monarchies that had been overthrown by Napoleon's armies were restored. In Spain, King Ferdinand VII was given back his father's throne; Italy was divided once again into scores of principalities; the 39-state German

Confederation was formed; Austria was given back most of the territories it had lost in Italy; Norway and Sweden were joined under a single ruler; and Russia was handed Finland and given effective control over the new kingdom of Poland.

But the forces to which the age of revolution gave birth were not so easily contained. Traditional loyalties to the old dynasties of Europe had declined; in their place came new loyalties to national groups and demands for nation-states. Over the following century, the old order of Europe would be fundamentally transformed.

National independence

Nationalist movements took two main forms in the 19th century: the political form of advocating independence from an alien rule; and the introduction of nationalist ideology to unite divided



Giuseppe Garibaldi

The Italian soldier and statesman Giuseppe Garibaldi became the hero of the Italian nationalist movement known as the *Risorgimento* ("resurgence").

against a foreign oppressor. In 1830, revolution also broke out in Belgium (part of the Kingdom of the Netherlands), and an independent Belgian state was formed in 1831.

A wave of radical agitation swept across Europe in 1848. In Paris the Bourbon monarchy, restored to the French throne in 1814, was overthrown and replaced by a republic. On hearing of events in France, the people of Vienna, Budapest, and Prague rose up against the Habsburg rulers of the

Austrian Empire. For a time, this empire (which covered much of central and southeastern Europe) showed signs of collapse, but the revolutions of 1848 failed within the Habsburg territories.

National unification

The national impulse that led to the division of the Ottoman Empire into independent nation-states could also act as a force for unification. In 1814,

1859. With the help of France, Piedmont repelled Austria, leaving the way open for Cavour to take control of most of northern and central Italy.

The following year the charismatic Italian patriot Giuseppe Garibaldi invaded southern Italy with an army of a thousand volunteer "Red Shirts" and conquered Sicily and Naples. By 1871, the unification of Italy was essentially complete. »



IRELAND

BEFORE

In the 18th century a number of national revivals made the concept of national identity a significant force in European politics.

MAGYAR RENAISSANCE

When **Joseph II**, the energetic ruler of the Habsburg Empire from 1780–90, decreed that German replace Latin as the empire's official language, the Hungarians (Magyars) in his empire reacted by insisting on the right to use their own tongue. This sparked a **renaissance** of Magyar Hungarian language and culture.



TREATY OF VIENNA

NATIONAL REVIVALS

The Magyar national reawakening subsequently triggered national revivals among the **Slovak**, **Romanian**, **Serbian**, and **Croatian** minorities within Hungary. In 1789, a **revolt** broke out in the **Austrian Netherlands** in reaction to the emperor's centralized policies, and in **Ireland** a swell of nationalism and a mass rebellion for **democratic rights** erupted against British rule in 1798. These revivals later blossomed into the nationalist movements of the 19th–20th centuries.

TREATY OF VIENNA

The **French Revolution** << 300–03 and the conquests of **Napoleon Bonaparte** << 304–07 shattered the old order of Europe and undermined many of the old certainties. The 1815 **Treaty of Vienna** was an attempt to redraw the borders of Europe and secure peace and stability.

“Let him who loves his country ... follow me.” GIUSEPPE GARIBALDI, 1882

groups within a state. Large, ethnically diverse states such as the Ottoman Empire (see pp.246–47) were particularly vulnerable to the first type of nationalist movement. During the first part of the 19th century, there was a series of uprisings by Greeks, Serbs, Romanians, and other ethnic groups within the Ottoman Empire. Serbia was semi-independent by 1817, and Greece declared its independence from the Ottomans in 1829. The Greek War of Independence, in particular, caught the imagination of writers and artists such as the poet Byron (see pp.338–39) and the painter Delacroix, helping stimulate a romantic ideal of national struggle

the Congress of Vienna had divided the Italian peninsula into a patchwork of independent states. In spite of this, the idea of a single Italian nation had potent popular appeal. A revolutionary society known as the *Carbonari* (coal-burners) agitated for national unification and organized insurrections, and in 1831 the Italian patriot and author Giuseppe Mazzini formed the political movement known as “Young Italy,” which called for one Italian nation – “independent, free, and Republican.” Italian statesmen were quick to grasp the opportunities. Cavour, the Prime Minister of Piedmont in northern Italy, provoked a war against Austria in

ATLANTIC OCEAN

Bay of Biscay



GIBRALTAR to Britain



The sick man of Europe

This cartoon depicts Abdul Hamid II, the last Ottoman emperor (ruled 1876–1909), having his empire whipped out from underneath him by Bulgaria and Austria. Bulgaria became independent from the Ottomans in 1908.